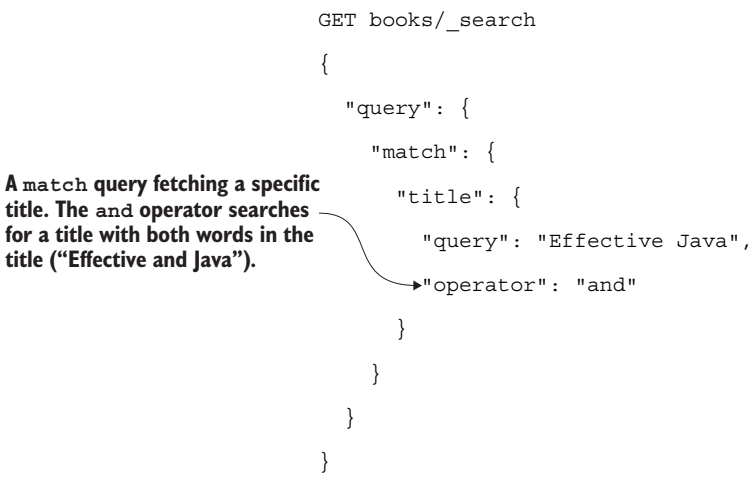


Figure 2.14 Fetching an exact match for a title using the `and` operator

Before we execute search queries that are a bit more involved, we need to do one little thing: index more documents. We only have three documents so far, and it would be helpful to have more for any meaningful queries. Elasticsearch provides a convenient bulk API (`_bulk`) to index documents in bulk. Let's take a short detour to index a few more documents, this time using the `_bulk` API.

2.3.3 Indexing documents using the _bulk API

We need to add more documents to our store as we start warming up to a variety of search queries. We can follow the same process of using document APIs as we did in section 2.1.2. However, as you can imagine, loading a lot of documents individually is a cumbersome process.

Fortunately, there's a handy `_bulk` API that lets us index documents simultaneously. We can use either Kibana or cURL to execute the `_bulk` API when indexing multiple documents, but the methods have differences in their data formats. We discuss the `_bulk` API at length in chapter 5; here, we briefly go over some highlights.

Bulk operation overrides existing data

If you perform the `_bulk` operation on books, it indexes them into the existing index (`books`) created at the beginning of the chapter. The new `book` documents have fields such as `price`, `rating`, and others; the object structure is enriched by these additional properties and differs from the earlier one.

If you don't want the existing `books` index to be touched, you can create a new index (`books_new`, perhaps) to avoid overriding the existing index. To do this, modify the index name in the bulk data file with the following line:

```
{"index":{"_index":"books_new","_id":"1"}}
```